Amol Appa Katkar, 39
Kiraksal, Man Block, Satara, Maharashtra



What makes him a water warrior: Amol Appa Katkar, known as '**Paaniwala Baba**', transformed his drought-prone Maharashtra village into a water-surplus model, conserving 31.37 crore liters through afforestation, voluntary labor, and scientific interventions. As Sarpanch, he banned borewells, built check dams and contour trenches, and mobilized the village for water conservation. His efforts earned him recognition as a 'Bhujal Mitra' under Atal Bhujal Yojana, with his water literacy workshops training 90+ residents. The impact was profound—reverse migration, booming agriculture, rising milk production, and biodiversity revival. Katkar's leadership proves that with vision and persistence, even arid lands can thrive.



Kamini Devi, 48
Begusarai, Bihar

What makes her a water warrior: Kamini Devi has transformed river conservation in Bihar, leading 1,000 women across seven panchayats to revive the Baya River, a Ganga tributary. Through her "**One Woman, One Water Pit**" initiative, households dug recharge pits, replenishing groundwater while repurposing invasive water hyacinths into organic fertilizer. Supported by Namami Gange and HESCO, her efforts restored river flow, improved soil fertility, and empowered women economically. More than a mission, her movement proves that sustainability thrives when communities take charge, turning everyday actions into collective transformation—where every woman becomes a custodian of water.

Rajendra Kr Tiwari, 53
Uttar Pradesh



What makes him a water warrior: Rajendra Kr Tiwari is a walking **billboard for the Ganga**, using his attire to spread awareness about pollution and conservation. Inspired by Swachh Bharat Mission, he turns everyday encounters into environmental activism, educating people about untreated sewage, industrial waste, and human negligence threatening the river. Beyond symbolism, he actively joins cleanliness drives, engages policymakers, and mobilizes communities to take responsibility. In a world where activism often stays online, Tiwari's relentless, on-the-ground efforts prove that real change happens one conversation at a time, keeping the fight for the Ganga's survival alive and visible.